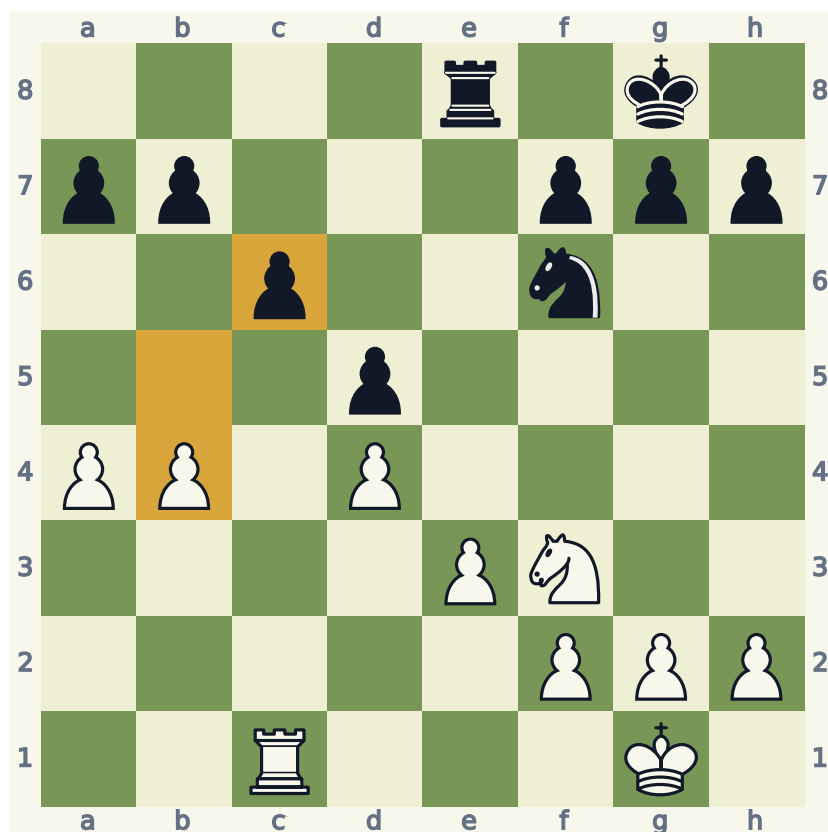


The minority attack

Use fewer pawns to create a lasting target.

In a Carlsbad-type structure, White's a- and b-pawns can attack Black's a-, b- and c-pawns. The usual goal is to create a weak c-pawn or another queenside target, not to force promotion. The attack must be timed against Black's central or kingside counterplay.

MODEL A | WHITE TO MOVE



READ THE POSITION

- White has two queenside pawns against three.
- b5 makes contact with c6.
- After ...cxb5, the c-file opens for Rc1.

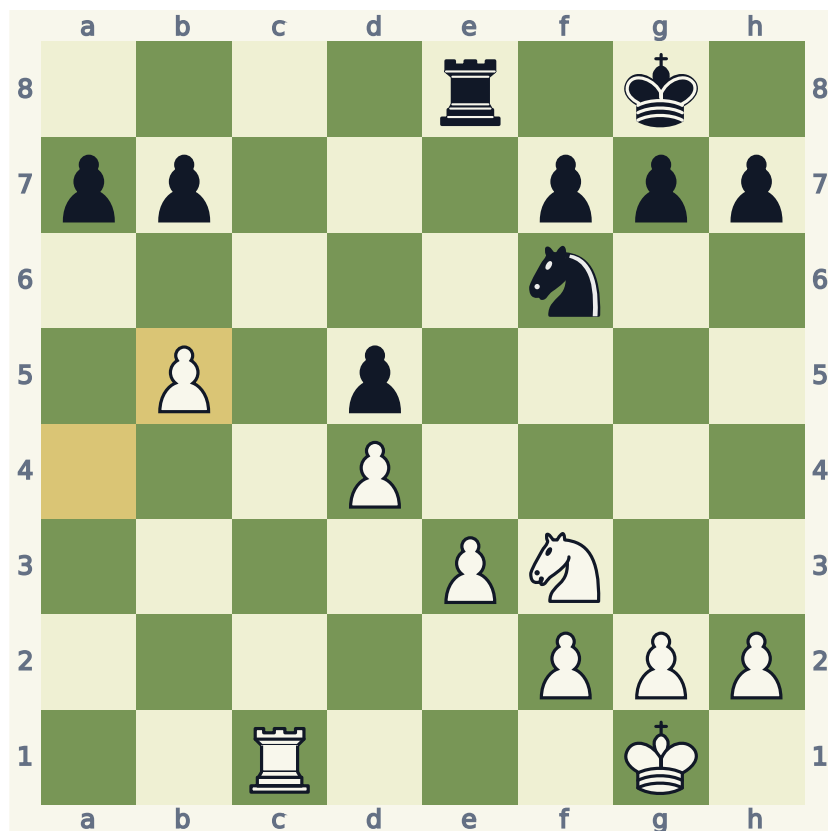
REMEMBER

- The goal is a target or useful open line.
- Prepare b5 and calculate every recapture.
- Watch the central counterbreak.

Follow the logic

1. b5 cxb5 2. axb5

MODEL A | POSITION AFTER THE LINE



b5

Challenge the queenside chain. White invites a capture that changes targets and files rather than trying to win a pawn by force.

...cxb5

Black takes the pawn. The old c-pawn is now on b5 and the c-file is clear.

axb5

White recaptures and opens the c-file. Rc7 may become an invasion idea, while the advanced b5-pawn restrains queenside squares. No pawn sacrifice was needed in this branch.

THE OPPONENT'S PLAN

Black can consider ...a6 or counterplay in the center. In fuller Carlsbad positions, piece activity and kingside threats may be faster than White's queenside attack.

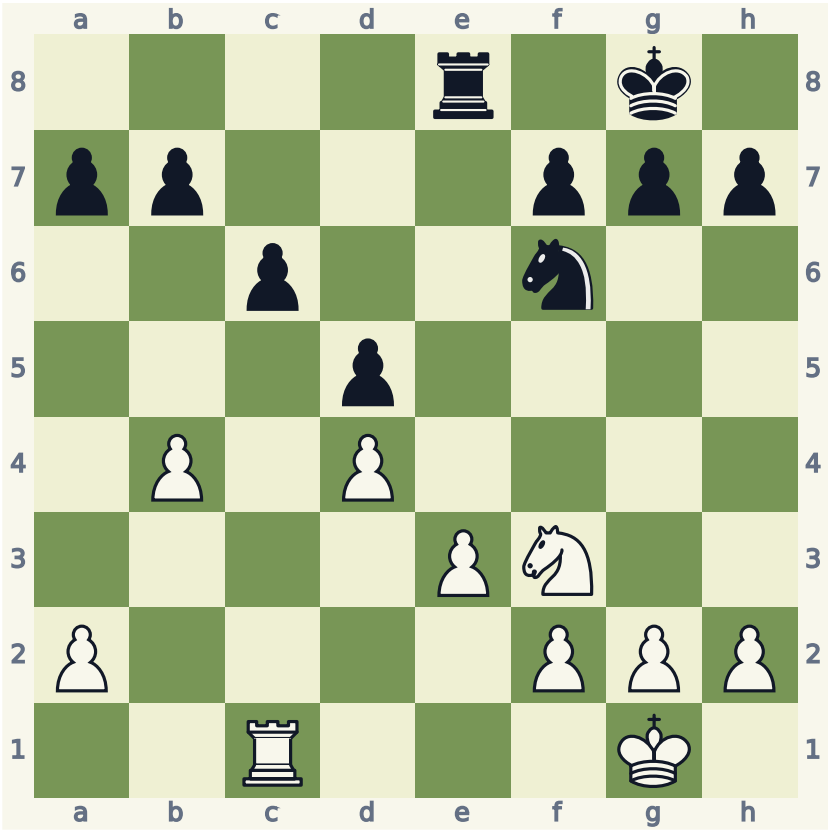
WHEN THE IDEA FAILS

Do not confuse the pattern with a forced sequence. After b5, Black can choose captures, maintain tension or counterattack. White must compare all replies before committing a pawn.

Find the plan

Set a timer for 6 minutes. Write the reasons, not just a move.

EXERCISE B | WHITE TO MOVE



- 1. What weakness remains after the sample exchanges?
- 2. Why is the c-file useful even though it is not fully open?
- 3. What should White do before adding more attackers?

CHANGE ONE FEATURE

If Black can achieve ...c5 under favorable conditions, has White's minority attack achieved a permanent target?

YOUR PLAN, THE OPPONENT'S REPLY, AND THE RESULTING POSITION

Position code (FEN): 4r1k1/pp3ppp/2p2n2/3p4/1P1P4/4PN2/P4PPP/2R3K1 w - - 0 1

Answers and transfer

1. Black has a pawn on c6, originally from b7, with no b-pawn neighbor. The a6-pawn does not directly support c6, and d5 supports c4/e4 rather than c6. The c6-pawn needs piece support or a useful advance.
2. White's rook can attack c6 along the semi-open c-file. The goal is to fix and pressure that pawn, not to jump through it to c7.
3. Check whether Black can safely play ...c5 and whether central or kingside counterplay is urgent. A second attacker is useful only if the target remains fixed long enough.

ONE ILLUSTRATIVE LEGAL LINE

1. b5 a6 2. bxc6 bxc6

Changed feature: Not necessarily. The c-pawn may exchange itself or gain activity, removing the weakness. White's success depends on the final structure and piece activity, not just completing b4-b5.

APPLY IT TO YOUR GAMES

Replay both sample branches after b5. List the different targets and rook routes in each resulting position.

Self-check: Award 0-2 points per numbered answer: 1 for the relevant fact, 1 for its consequence. Add 2 for the changed-feature answer. Revisit the lesson at 5/8 or below; repeat from memory tomorrow and one week later.

Related topics: 06, 11, 13. | Reference links and notation key: 00_Start_Here.pdf.